KAZI WALEED AHMED

view Portfolio

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Brand and creative leader with **8+ years** across network agencies and production studios, building and executing integrated brand plans for Fortune 500 FMCG portfolios across the GCC and MENAP. Steered brands through repositioning, peak inflation, and political disruptions, lifting brand affinity by up to **18%**, sales by **11%** and category share by **20%**. Combines consumer insight with compelling storytelling and **AI-workflows** to drive results & decide where investment goes.



EXPERIENCE

Regional Creative Lead | ***Helium Marketing - MENA*** — ***UAE • 2025 – present***

- Spearheading brand strategy and creative direction for a **$16M** portfolio (PepsiCo, Unilever, Barbican and more) across **6** GCC markets, delivering **40+** integrated brand activations and campaigns annually.
- Developed the winning 'Raise The Game' strategy to pivot Barbican toward evening social occasions for the AFC Champions League partnership. Executed the **$700K+** GCC-wide campaign across **4** markets, spanning stadium, retail, digital, and a consumer promotion microsite.
- Run 4 live pitches a month at a **60% win-rate** against Omnicom, Publicis and local agencies while managing a cross-functional team of strategists, creatives, designers, animators. Won Dubai Holding's corporate creative business from their aligned network agency in our **first** pitch.
- Instituted and mentor a **'think tank'** team of bright creatives, originating proactive concepts for seasons, launches and cultural moments, generating **2-3** large-scale pitches a month at **~30% conversion** in our first year.
- Designed and executed a **10x10m** activation for Sting at MDLBEAST Riyadh 2025, driving **14K+** samplings, **240K+** organic impressions, alongside Flamin' Hot's KSA culinary activation (3 cities) that earned an Outstanding Activation nomination at the Saudi Event Awards 2025.
- Led campaigns for DZRT's repositioning to 'Breathe Life' via content, digital activations, and experience platforms on-ground.
- Directed Close Up's 'White Now' 3D campaign (26 assets), using performance data to optimize real-time assets driving a **+32% retention lift**.
- Deliver Unilever Food Solutions content e2e: an **always-on** slate of recipe films, photography, social assets and creatives for brand partnerships.
- Art directed seasonal packaging across 5 PepsiCo snack ranges, **saving 24%** of production budget while upholding global design standards.

Creative Director | ***Adcom Leo Burnett*** — ***PK • 2024 – 2025***

- Led **2** of the market's **largest** portfolios – Procter & Gamble (MENAP) and Philip Morris – at Effie's 2025 Network Agency of the Year.
- Conceived and executed Safeguard's first brand repositioning in 20 years with 'Hifazat Ka Allrounder' campaign alongside Ariel's value-tier rollout during peak inflation, driving an **18%** brand affinity lift and protecting **78%** of baseline sales volume for Ariel.
- Developed the 'Shhh Nahi Shhhare' campaign for Always from a consumer insight on cultural silence around period discomfort, repositioning an improved product around confidence vs compromise, achieving **96% positive** brand perception **reversing** two years of **20%** market-share decline.
- Wrote ZYN's 2.0 campaign slate of **15** DVCs and directed **CGI** variant-launches, navigating strict regulatory guardrails on a tier-1 market budget, contributing to a **20% category share growth** against the legacy player.
- Associate-directed **5 DVCs** through post, presented to global brand teams and market stakeholders, and integrated AI tools into team workflows to accelerate output while preserving human craft and insight.

Associate Creative Director | ***MullenLowe*** — ***PK • 2021 – 2024***

- **Portfolio:** Unilever, Dalda Foods, KIA Motors, EFU Life, Shangrila Foods, and TrueCoverage, across 2 global markets.
- Led and mentored a cross-functional team of **12** across **11** brand accounts over my tenure, running creative ideation, review, and feedback while reporting directly to the CCO, and introduced **agency-wide** AI workflows across copy, design and video.
- Modernized legacy FMCG brands for younger demographics, driving **11%** sales increase and an Effie Gold for Dalda by engaging millennial consumers, and reworked Knorr's bouillon brand identity for Gen-Z through thematic TVCs and strategic creator partnerships.
- Secured **2** new brands and won back **2** departing ones through pitches I led, expanding my team by **4** and growing the agency retainer base by **20%**.
- Repositioned KIA Stonic against the category's two best-selling sedans through an award-winning **multi-series** DVC campaign.
- Created the brand identity, strategy, and **360°** omnichannel launch campaign for EFU Life's WIN wellness app, **winning** Insurance Asia Award 2022.

Creative Producer | ***SEEME Productions , Tall Man Films , Digital Invasion Films*** — ***UAE & PK • 2018 – 2021***

- Produced, wrote and directed branded content and entertainment properties for clients including EBM, National Foods, Domino's, Oppo and Bayer, owning budgets, production, post-production, photography, and sponsorships, collaborating with global directors and crew.
- Produced **16+** TVCs, an Effie-winning 12-episode web series, and **directed all BTS** content across the films and DVC projects.
- Stood up a new **OTT** and **cinema content division** end to end, delivering **2** theatrical feature films and pre-producing **1** web series for OTT.
- Created 'Digestive Showtime', a **5-film** content platform for YouTube with **15M+** views in our 1st month, coordinating **5** directors and crews of **150**.

SKILLS

Concept development and campaign platforms · integrated brand planning · creative brief development · consumer insight · copywriting · team leadership, mentoring and creative review · new business pitching and proposal development · presenting to senior clients · AI production workflows · packaging design · end-to-end DVC/film production · category and consumer analysis · experience and activation design · DVC/ film direction

Tools: Claude, Higgsfield, ElevenLabs, Google Flow, Office 365, Keynote, Final Cut Pro, Adobe CC | **Languages:** English, Urdu, Arabic (learning)

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

• **Outstanding Activation** Nominee, Saudi Event Awards — Flamin' Hot Culinary Activation	@ Helium MENA	**2025**
• **Best Social Good Brand, Dragons of Asia** — Always – 'Changing the Narrative'	@ Adcom Leo Burnett	**2025**
• **Sustainability & Environment, Dragons of Asia** — Ariel – 'Sustainability at Home'	@ Adcom Leo Burnett	**2024**
• **Effie Award, Gold** — Dalda Foods 'Jahan Maamta Wahan Dalda'	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
• **Effie Award, Bronze** — Tullo 'Restaging the Kids'	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
• **iF Design Award** — KIA Stonic "#PlayItYoung"	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
• **Effie Award, Bronze** — 'National Ketchup Factory' Web Series (12 Episodes)	@ Digital Invasion	**2020**

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Media Science, Film & TV — Iqra University | Dean's Honor List 2018 — **CGPA 3.8**
- Bachelor Studies, Computer Science — Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute | 2014 - 2016